



Same Game, Different Package

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With the GOW legacy, our hopes for Ascension were high. If you are a God of War fan, you will love this game come what may. It has the familiar elements that defines the franchise like gruesome kills, big boss battles and of course Kratos himself.

The story this time around is a prequel to the first game and Kratos is on a mission to break the oath he made with Ares, the God of War. In breaking the oath he is captured by the Furies who wants to imprison him for his betrayal. The story is pretty straightforward with the occasional plot twists thrown into the mix. One good thing is that the story juggles between the past and the present trying to keep things interesting. The gameplay stays true to tradition with the improvement in combat controls and we appreciate the change even though it may take veterans of the franchise some getting used to. Unlike GOW3, Kratos doesn't have access to a variety of weapons. Instead, you can upgrade the blades with the power of different Gods (Ares, Zeus, Poseidon and Hades) to give

you access to different moves. You can also pick up secondary weapons for a brief period mixing up the combat. The enemies are mix of the old and new and there are times when you think that you are playing GOW3 until something new pops up on screen. The graphics of the Game are as good as, if not better than, GOW3 and that is impressive. The game ran smoothly and there are points where the camera pans out to show you the grand scale of the game.

Apart from combat, there are puzzles and quite a few traversing elements in the game. The puzzles have a very GOW1 feel to them. The sound design and voice acting is one place where we have always loved the GOW franchise, and this is still where the series delivers. From the narrative voice of Gaia to the deep and troubled voice acting of Kratos and the rest of the cast on board, the voice acting and production quality is awesome. One very good thing about Ascension is that the save points have vanished for an auto save system in the game. So now you don't need to get distracted from the core experience to save – a thing that should have been implemented a long time ago in the series. With Ascension, the series has seen the introduction of multiplayer.

Put simply, if you are one who enjoys Call of Duty multiplayer, you may not enjoy this. But if you love hack and slash, you should give it a go. There are team bases as well as individual modes, where players pledge their alliance to a God and gain abilities and moves accordingly. The only drawback with the multiplayer is that match making took quite a bit of time. *

Verdict

Overall, God is War Ascension is a game that stays true to its roots with little deviation. Fans of the franchise will feel right at home with a tad bit of repetition. The story is quite straightforward, graphics are great and the campaign is a bit shorter than we'd like. The multiplayer is a hit or miss depending on your taste. *

MOAR!

- » **Developer:** SCE Santa Monica Studio
- » **Publisher:** Sony Computer Entertainment
- » **Platform:** PS3
- » **Price:** ₹2,999



STUNNING DESIGN

Elegant looks
Premium craftsmanship
Superior acoustics

